

A Winter Tale

The North Wind was **pleased**. He **frolicked** among the trees in the forest and watched with **glee** as the leaves **shrivelled up** and dropped from the branches. The **sight** of **bare** branches covered with snow excited him.

While the North Wind was **at play**, he did not notice a little **swallow** on the ground, **shivering** with cold. The bird's wing was broken and he could not fly. All his friends had flown south to warmer **climes**, leaving him alone to **fend** for himself until spring came.

The swallow did not know what to do. **Perhaps** the trees will keep me warm through the winter, he thought. He **hopped** to the nearest tree. It was a silver **birch**, **slender** and tall.

"Fair birch tree, will you let me live in your branches until the spring?" the swallow asked.

The proud birch tree **frowned** and said, "I have to look after my own leaves during the winter. I don't have place for anyone else. Begone!"

Disappointed, the swallow hopped ahead and came to an oak tree. Tall and **majestic**, it had the **sturdiest trunk** and thickest branches of all the trees in the forest.

The swallow **chirped** and said, "O **mighty oak**, will you give me shelter in your strong **boughs** and keep me warm for the winter?"



The oak **grunted** and said, "No, no, no! If I let you stay, you will eat up all my **acorns**. Go away before I shake you off!"

The **disheartened** swallow **fluttered** and hopped ahead and met the **shady** willow tree.

Elegant one, will you let me live in your warm branches until springtime comes?" asked the swallow.

The willow tree **swayed** his fine branches and **brushed** the swallow **aside**. "Hmph! I don't speak to strangers. Go away"

Close to tears and hurting, the little swallow hopped around, feeling lost and lonely. A kindly **spruce** tree saw what had happened and took **pity**.

He **called out** to the swallow and said, "Little bird, you may live in my branches, Here is a warm spot."

"Will you let me live with you all winter?" asked the swallow, **timidly**.

"Yes, I would like the company" said the spruce.

The **sinewy** pine tree behind the spruce **shook off** the soft snow, revealing his **spindly** leaves. He said, "I can't offer you a warm place to stay, but I am big and strong. I can keep off the freezing wind."



A nearby **juniper** tree **lush** with purple fruit, also **chipped in**. "Don't worry little bird. You can **feast** on my **berries** all you want. So you will not go hungry this winter"

And so, filled with relief and happiness, the swallow flew up to the spruce tree and **settled down**. **At long last**, he was comforted by the thought of surviving the winter with the help of his new friends.

The silver birch, oak and willow watched the happy swallow and **pouted**. The birch remarked **haughtily**, "I would not take care of another creature when I have to **look after** myself!"

"I would not **put** my acorns **at risk** by inviting birds to live with me," said the mighty oak.

"I would not speak to a stranger," said the pretty willow.

The three trees stood tall and proud, set in their selfish ways.

That night, the North Wind **blew** his way through the forest. He **huffed** and he **puffed**, his icy breath felling the leaves **in scores**. He wanted to touch every leaf, so he asked his father, the Frost King, if he could.

"No," said the Frost King. "**Spare** the trees which were **kind** to the little swallow with the broken wing. They may keep their leaves."

Thus by the order of the Frost King, the spruce, pine and juniper got to keep their leaves all through the winter, while the other trees lost their **foliage**. This is why evergreen trees keep their leaves all through the year, winter or summer!

Vocabulary

1. **Pleased** (adjective) – happy, content, satisfied, delighted, glad – प्रसन्न
2. **Frolic** (verb) – romp, play, skip, gambol, cavort – उछल-कूद करना
3. **Glee** (noun) – joy, delight, elation, happiness, merriment – आनंद
4. **Shrivel up** (phrasal verb) – wither, dry, wilt, shrink, decay – सिकुड़ जाना
5. **Sight** (noun) – view, scene, spectacle, vision, appearance – दृश्य
6. **Bare** (adjective) – naked, exposed, uncovered, stripped, empty – नंगा/ खाली
7. **At play** (phrase) – in action, in motion, active, functioning, operative – क्रियाशील
8. **Swallow** (noun) – bird, songbird, passerine, flier, migrant – अबाबील (एक पक्षी)
9. **Shiver** (verb) – tremble, shake, quiver, shudder, shudder – कांपना
10. **Clime** (noun) – region, zone, area, climate, land – क्षेत्र (जलवायु संबंधी)
11. **Fend (for oneself)** (verb) – manage, cope, survive, subsist, defend – रक्षा करना
12. **Perhaps** (adverb) – maybe, possibly, conceivably, likely, perchance – शायद
13. **Hop** (verb) – jump, leap, skip, bound, bounce – उछलना
14. **Birch** (noun) – tree, hardwood, timber, deciduous, flora – एक प्रकार का वृक्ष
15. **Slender** (adjective) – thin, slim, narrow, lean, slight – पतला
16. **Frown** (verb) – scowl, glare, grimace, glower, brood – भौंहें चढ़ाना
17. **Majestic** (adjective) – grand, regal, noble, splendid, stately – भव्य
18. **Sturdy** (adjective) – strong, tough, robust, firm, solid – मजबूत
19. **Trunk** (noun) – stem, bole, base, stalk, shaft – तना
20. **Chirp** (verb) – twitter, tweet, peep, warble, sing – चहचहाना
21. **Mighty** (adjective) – powerful, great, strong, immense, dominant – शक्तिशाली
22. **Oak** (noun) – hardwood, tree, timber, deciduous, flora – बलूत का पेड़
23. **Bough** (noun) – branch, limb, shoot, sprig, offshoot – शाखा
24. **Grunt** (verb) – groan, growl, snort, murmur, grumble – गुर्राना
25. **Acorn** (noun) – nut, seed, fruit, kernel, capsule – बलूत फल

26. **Disheartened** (adjective) – discouraged, depressed, dejected, demoralized, dispirited – निराश
27. **Flutter** (verb) – flap, quiver, flicker, flit, hover – फड़फड़ाना
28. **Shady** (adjective) – shadowy, cool, dim, sunless, protected – छायादार
29. **Elegant** (adjective) – graceful, stylish, refined, tasteful, sophisticated – सुंदर
30. **Sway** (verb) – swing, wave, rock, bend, tilt – झूलना
31. **Brush aside** (phrasal verb) – dismiss, ignore, reject, spurn, neglect – ठुकराना
32. **Spruce** (noun) – fir, pine, conifer, evergreen, tree – स्प्रूस वृक्ष
33. **Pity** (noun) – compassion, sympathy, sorrow, mercy, concern – दया
34. **Call out** (phrasal verb) – summon, shout, beckon, hail, appeal – पुकारना
35. **Timidly** (adverb) – shyly, nervously, hesitantly, meekly, fearfully – डरते हुए
36. **Sinewy** (adjective) – muscular, strong, brawny, lean, rugged – मजबूत
37. **Shake off** (phrasal verb) – rid, remove, throw off, get rid of, dislodge – हटाना
38. **Spindly** (adjective) – thin, lanky, slender, weak, tall – लम्बा और पतला
39. **Juniper** (adjective) – related to juniper tree, evergreen, shrubby, needle-leaved, woody – जुनिपर पौधों से संबंधित
40. **Lush** (adjective) – rich, abundant, green, flourishing, thriving – घना
41. **Chip in** (verb) – contribute, donate, offer, assist, give – योगदान देना
42. **Feast** (noun) – banquet, spread, meal, celebration, repast – दावत
43. **Berry** (noun) – fruit, drupe, seed, produce, pod – बेरी फल
44. **Settle down** (phrasal verb) – relax, stay, establish, nest, roost – बस जाना
45. **At long last** (phrase) – finally, eventually, after a long time, in the end, at last – अंततः
46. **Pout** (verb) – sulk, frown, glower, mope, complain – होंठ फुलाना
47. **Haughtily** (adverb) – arrogantly, proudly, disdainfully, loftily, snobbishly – घमंड से
48. **Look after** (phrasal verb) – take care of, attend, watch, mind, tend – देखभाल करना
49. **Put at risk** (phrase) – endanger, expose, imperil, threaten, jeopardize – खतरे में डालना
50. **Blow** (verb) – gust, puff, move air, waft, exhale – फूंक मारना / हवा चलना

51. **Huff** (verb) – puff, blow, pant, breathe
hard, exhale – जोर से सांस छोड़ना

52. **Puff** (verb) – blow, breathe, exhale, gasp,
pant – फूंक मारना

53. **In scores** (phrase) – in large numbers,
abundantly, in great quantity, by dozens,
massively – बड़ी संख्या में

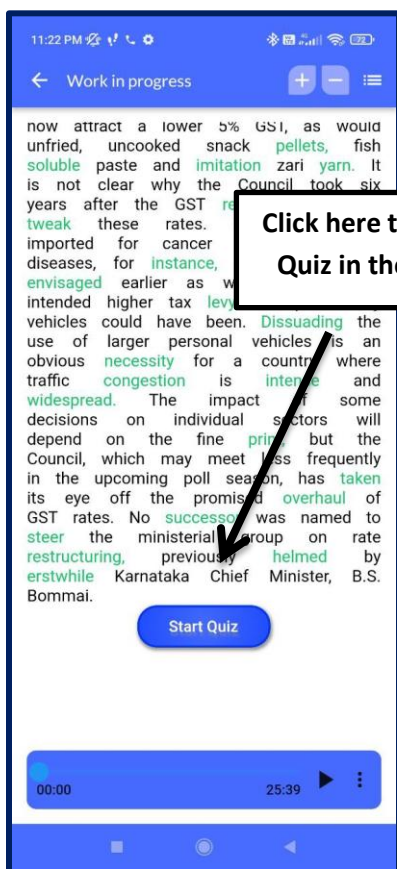
54. **Spare** (verb) – save, preserve, leave,
exempt, withhold – छोड़ देना

55. **Kind** (adjective) – caring, gentle, generous,
compassionate, benevolent – दयालु

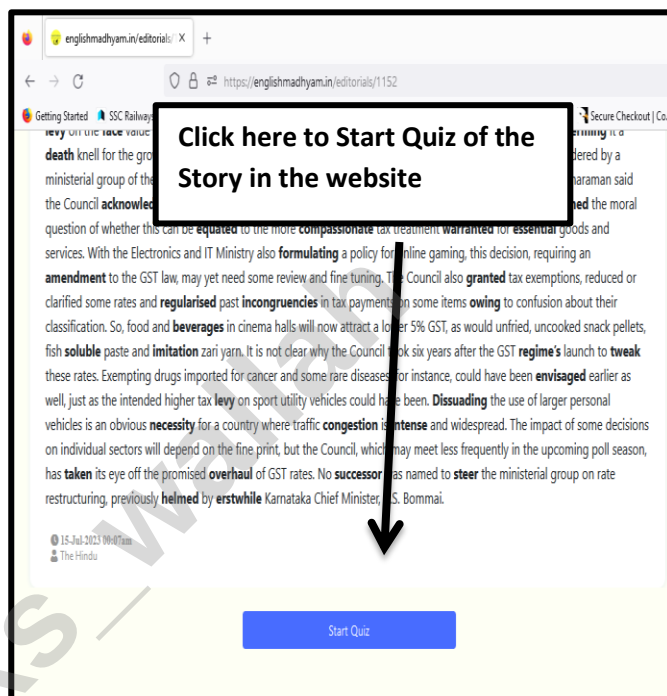
56. **Foliage** (noun) – leaves, greenery,
vegetation, fronds, flora – पत्तियां

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Practice Exercise



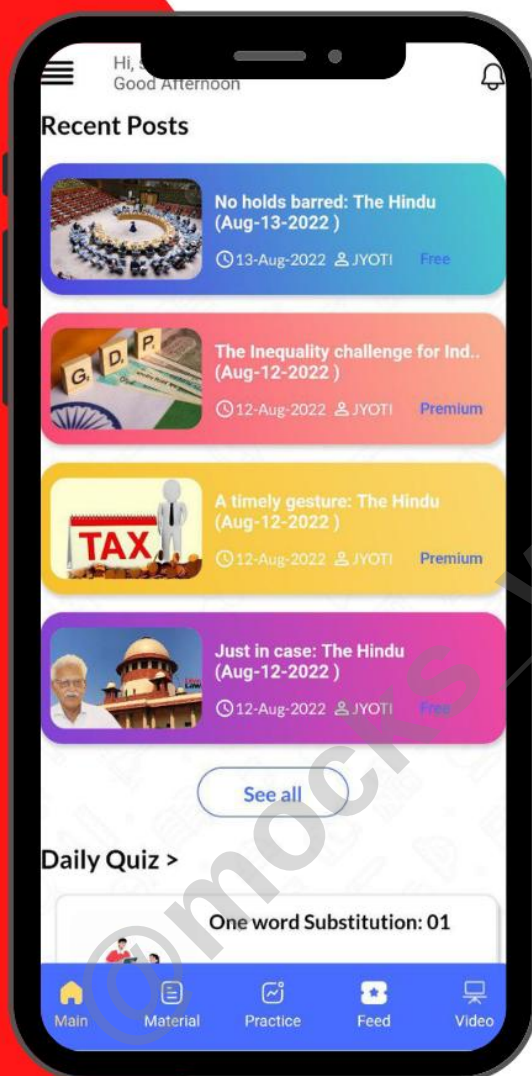
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